



Royal Geelong Yacht Club inc.



Charlie Course
Sailing Instructions

1st October 2021 to
30th September 2022

Royal Geelong Yacht Club Inc.
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Charlie Course Sailing Instructions Season 2021/2022

1 Rules

- 1.1** Races will be governed by the rules as defined in The Racing Rules of Sailing (RRS) and the Australian Sailing (AS) Special Regulations Part 1 and Part 2.
- 1.2** COVID 19 restrictions, regulations and guidelines shall apply as specified by the Victorian State Government and the Australian Government.

1.3 Boats in Danger

Within the waters of Corio Bay, Commercial Shipping has right-of-way whether that Vessel is in a channel or otherwise. Any boat in the anticipated path of a commercial vessel may use every alternative means of propulsion to avoid collision provided that:

- Propulsion is used to drive the boat the minimum distance necessary to avoid collision.
- The course taken is no closer than 90 degrees to the direction of the next mark
- The boat completes a two-turn penalty immediately on resumption of racing.
- Nothing in the Notice of Race or Sailing Instructions relieves a boat of her responsibility under civil law to comply with the International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea or local regulations.
- Between sunset and sunrise, competitors are reminded that part of the definition of “room” includes taking into account the existing conditions (including visibility).

Refer to Appendix A for more information

1.4 AS Special Regulations Categories

- 1.4.1 Category for each Series and Class are as per Notice of Race 4.1
- 1.4.2 As per Notice of Race 4.9 any boat that is found to be non-compliant with its required AS Special Regulation Category will be scored DSQ without a hearing for all races prior to successful completion of the audit. This changes RRS 63.1, A4 and A5.

1.5 Safety Requirements

- 1.5.1 Every Crew Member of a boat not equipped with lifelines shall wear a lifejacket.
- 1.5.2 A Man Overboard (MOB) compliance declaration must be lodged with the RGYC office prior to 31st December 2021. MOB compliance forms are available [HERE](#).
- 1.5.3 A boat which has not lodged a MOB compliance declaration by that date will be scored DSQ without a hearing for all races prior to submission of the declaration. This changes RRS 63.1, A4 and A5.

1.6 Retractable Keels

Retractable keels must be locked down at all times when racing.

1.7 Flag V – Search and Rescue

When the Race Committee displays Flag V with one sound, all boats and official & support vessels will, if possible, monitor the race committee communications channel for search and rescue instructions.

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2 Changes to Sailing Instructions (SI's)

- 2.1 Any change to the Sailing Instructions, other than as per SI 2.3, will be posted before 09:00 hours on the day it will take effect, except that any change to the schedule of races will be posted with three (3) days clear notice. This notice will be displayed on the Official Notice Board (ONB) located East of the Club's slipway.
- 2.2 Flag L will be displayed from the Club's flagpole to signify that a notice to competitors has been posted.
- 2.3 The Race Committee may issue a change of SI's from the Race Committee Vessel (RCV) by displaying Flag 3rd substitute with three sounds. Further instructions will be issued by radio.

3 Communications to Competitors

- 3.1 Notices to competitors will be posted on the ONB. Notices may also be placed on the notice board within the Club's Members Bar.
- 3.2 All radio communications will be conducted on VHF Channel 73.
- 3.3 Boats are required to keep a listening watch on the designated radio frequency for their course and channel 16 at all times during racing.
- 3.4 The Race Committee may broadcast the course to be sailed, names/sail numbers of OCS boats, and/or other information. Any failure of, or defect in, such a broadcast will not be grounds for redress. This changes RRS 60.1(b) and 62.
- 3.5 [DP] While racing, except in an emergency, a boat shall not make voice or data transmissions and not receive voice or data communication that is not available to all boats.

4 Signals Made Ashore

- 4.1 Signals made ashore will be displayed from the Club's flagpole located in the North-West corner of the Club's property.
- 4.2 When a signal is displayed over a class flag it applies to that class only.
- 4.3 When Flag AP is displayed ashore, '1 minute' is replaced with 'not less than 45 minutes'. This changes RRS Race Signals AP.

5 Schedule of Races

- 5.1 Race dates and time of first warning signals are scheduled as per the RGYC Season 2021-2022 Racing Calendar and is available [HERE](#).
- 5.2 If the L flag is displayed on the RCV at the finishing line an additional race will be sailed.

6 Class Flags

6.1

Class and or Division	Flag Description
Etchells	Etchell Class Flag 
VX One & Sportsboats	Numeral Pennant 9 

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7 Racing Areas

7.1 The racing area will be on Corio Bay.

8 Courses and Marks

8.1 These are listed in Appendix B.

9 The Start

9.1 The starting line is between a staff displaying an orange flag on the RCV at the starboard-end and the course side of a port-end starting mark as described in Appendix B.

9.2 [DP] Boats whose warning signal has not been made shall avoid the starting area during the starting sequence for other races.

9.3 A boat failing to start within 10 minutes after her starting signal will be scored “Did Not Start” (DNS) without a hearing. This changes RRS 63.1, A4 and A5.

10 The Finish

10.1 The finishing line is between a staff displaying a blue flag on the RCV and the course side of the finish mark.

10.2 [DP] Boats not racing shall stay clear of the finish line.

11 Time Limits

11.1 The time limits for all boats to sail the courses and finish are shown with each course description.

11.2 Boats still racing after the limit expires will be scored DNF without a hearing. This changes RRS 35, A5.1 and A5.2

11.3 The Finishing Windows for each race course are outlined in Appendix B.

11.4 The Finishing Window is the time for boats to finish after the first boat sails the course and finishes. Boats failing to finish within the Finishing Window, and not subsequently retiring, penalized or given redress, will be scored DNF without a hearing. This changes RRS 35, A5.1 and A5.2.

12 Protests and Requests for Redress

12.1 Forms and Lodgement

Hearing Request forms are available from the box beside the results notice board located in the Club Member’s Bar. Protests and requests for redress or reopening shall be delivered to the Race Officer, Club Captain, Vice Commodore or the Sailing Manager within the appropriate time limit.

12.2 Protest Time Limit

The protest time limit is 90 minutes after the last boat in her division has finished the last race of the day or the Race Committee signals “No more racing today”, whichever is later.

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12.3 Notices will be posted as soon as practicable to inform competitors of the date, time and place of hearings in which they are parties or named as witnesses.

13 Scoring

13.1 Boats that join the series after one or more completed races will be scored DNC for each earlier race.

13.2 Rule A5.3 applies.

13.3 Number of Races required

For each series, six (6) races are required to be completed to constitute a series.

13.4 Number of Boats to Start

A minimum of three boats are required to start in a class or division for a race to be scored. This changes RRS 90.3 (a), A4 and A5.

13.5 Discards

Series	Races Completed	Discards
Full Season aggregate	1 – 6	0
Full Season aggregate	7 – 12	1
Full Season aggregate	13 – 18	2
Full Season aggregate	19 or more	3

13.6 Requests for allocated race score

13.6.1 A boat which completes in a Class Championship at State, National or World level can request the RGYC Sailing & Boating Committee for an allocated score.

13.6.2 Boats which do not race because its crew have volunteered as race management on a particular race day can request the RGYC Sailing & Boating Committee for an allocated score.

13.6.3 Allocated scores will be applied as follows:

- i) The boat's allocated race score shall be the average of her race scores for the season excluding RDG and other allocated scores. The value of this number may change as the season progresses.
- ii) Requests under 13.6.1 will be scored AVG.
- iii) Request under 13.6.2 will be scored DUT (Duty).
- iv) A boat may be given an allocated score for a maximum of 2 Club race days per season.

This changes RRS A4 and A5.

14 Resailed Events

14.1 Races not completed on the scheduled day may be rescheduled at the discretion of the Race Committee.

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15 Changes to Boats

15.1 The Handicap Committee shall be notified in writing (email or letter) of any changes by 17:00 hours of the business day before the race. These changes include but not limited to;

- Change of Helmsperson, particularly of someone outside of regular crew
- New sails
- Changes to rig, ballast, LOA, rudder, keel etc

16 Radio Sign On & Off

16.1 Sign On

Boats departing the Marina shall notify RG Base on VHF 71 of the name of the boat, the sail number and the number of people on board. If there is no response, boats shall notify the RCV.

16.2 Sign Off

16.2.1 Upon return to the marina boats shall notify RG Base VHF 71, the name of the boat sail number and the number of people on board. If there is no response, boats shall notify the RCV.

16.2.2 Boats failing to sign-on or sign-off may be scored their finish score plus five (5) points for the first race of the day, but not worse than the score for DSQ without a hearing. The scores of other boats shall not be changed. This changes RRS 63.1, A4 and A5.

16.2.3 A boat that retires from a race shall notify RG Base or the RCV as soon as possible.

16.2.4 If RG Base or the RCV cannot be contacted as per SI 16.2.1, call or SMS either the Club Captain Phil Francis on 0419 317 680 or Vice Commodore Roger Bennett on 0417 124 186.

17 Crew Declarations

17.1 This crew declaration process is not substituted by the RGYC Site sign in required under current COVID restrictions and using the QR Code scan process.

17.2 No later than the boat's preparatory signal the owner or delegate shall submit a Crew Declaration containing boat name, sail number and the full name & membership status of each person on board

17.3 This crew declaration shall be lodged electronically by downloading and lodging the declaration through the Memberpoint App. This app can be downloaded via the following links: For [Android devices, CLICK HERE](#), and [Apple devices, CLICK HERE](#)

17.4 Crew without RGYC membership, may obtain a Sailpass through the MemberPoint App prior to being available for selection as crew. Please note that the number of Sailpasses that an individual can obtain is currently limited to 12 (lifetime total).

17.5 Boats failing to comply may be scored DSQ by the Race Committee without a hearing. The scores of other boats shall not be changed. This changes RRS 63.1, A4 and A5.

18 Equipment and Measurement Checks

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- 18.1** A boat or equipment may be inspected at any time for compliance with the class rules and sailing instructions. On the water, a boat can be instructed by a Sailing and Boating Committee appointed Safety Officer to proceed immediately to a designated area for inspection.

19 Disclaimer of Liability

- 19.1** RRS 3 states: 'The responsibility for a boat's decision to participate in a race or to continue to race is hers alone.' By participating in this event each competitor agrees and acknowledges that sailing is a potentially dangerous activity with inherent risks. These risks include strong winds and rough seas, sudden changes in weather, failure of equipment, boat handling errors, poor seamanship by other boats, loss of balance on an unstable platform and fatigue resulting in increased risk of injury. **Inherent in the sport of sailing is the risk of permanent, catastrophic injury or death by drowning, trauma, hypothermia or other causes.**

20 Insurance

- 20.1** Each participating boat shall be insured, with racing risk, and valid third-party liability insurance with a minimum cover of \$10,000,000, per incident.

APPENDIX A: Commercial Shipping

A1 Victoria Marine Safety Regulations and in particular Rule Part 6, 112 (2)

Nothing in these Rules shall exonerate any vessel, or the owner, master or crew thereof, from the consequences of any neglect to comply with these Rules or of the neglect of any precaution which may be required by the ordinary practice of seamen, or by the special circumstances of the case.

In complying with these Rules due regard shall be had to all dangers of navigation and collision and to any special circumstances, including the limitations of the vessels involved, which may make a departure from these Rules necessary to avoid immediate danger.

If a boat is about to be involved in a collision, having stood or not given way in accordance with the Rule; every party involved is responsible in taking avoiding action to prevent a collision.

A2 Local Rules

These Local Rules require sail craft to keep clear of commercial shipping. Pass at least 500m ahead of the ship's bow. Any boat not compliant shall be disqualified without a hearing. This changes RRS A4, A5 and 63.1.

A3 Bow Flare

When closing on any vessel, to prevent being overrun, ensure you can sight the vessel's bridge. Beware of overhanging bows and other parts of ship that might obstruct this line of sight.

A4 Boats in Danger

Within the waters of Port Philip and Corio Bay, Commercial Shipping has right-of-way whether that Vessel is in a channel or otherwise. Any boat-operator in the anticipated path of a commercial vessel, may use every alternative means of propulsion to avoid collision provided that:

- Propulsion is used to drive the boat the minimum distance necessary to avoid collision.
- The course taken is no closer than 90 degrees to the direction of the next mark
- The boat completes a two-turn penalty immediately on resumption of racing.
- Nothing in the Notice of Race or Sailing Instructions relieves a boat of her responsibility under civil law to comply with the International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea or local regulations.
- Between sunset and sunrise, competitors are reminded that part of the definition of "room" includes taking into account the existing conditions (including visibility).

Competitors are reminded of their responsibility under rule 9(b) of the IRPCS, (b) "A vessel of less than 20 metres in length or a sailing vessel shall not impede the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway."

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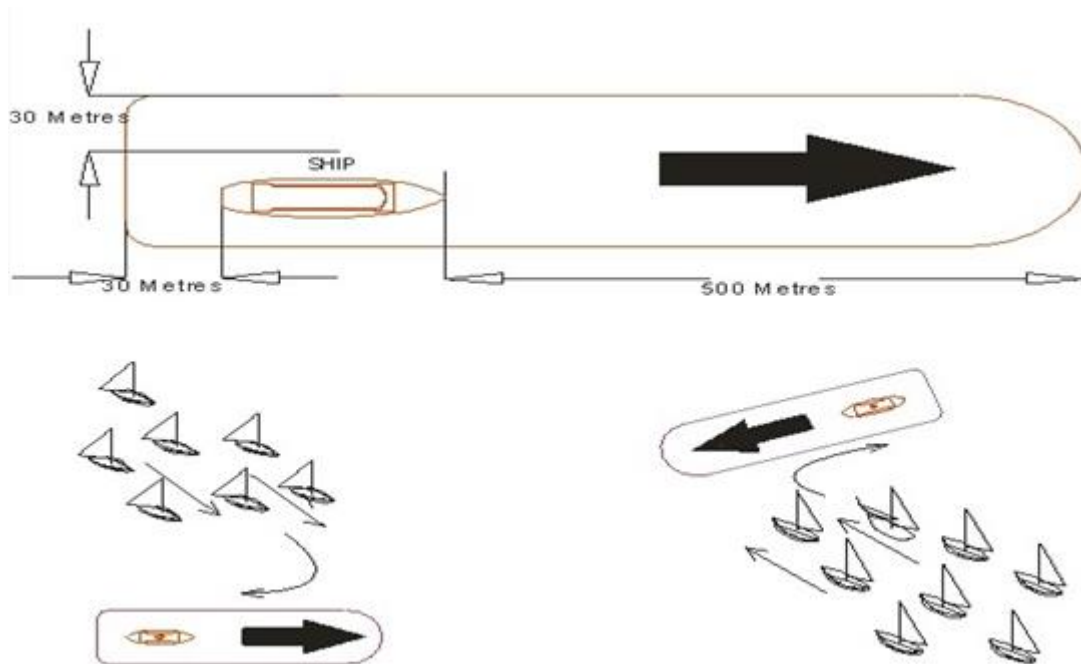
A5 Shipping Sound Signal Meanings:

One short blast – *I am altering course to starboard (right).*

Two short blasts – *I am altering course to port (left).*

Three short blasts – *I am operating engines astern.*

Five (or more) short blasts – *I'm unsure of your intentions and doubt whether you are taking enough avoiding action to avoid collision.*



Appendix B: Courses

Windward-Leeward – Course 1

Indicated by display of Flag F

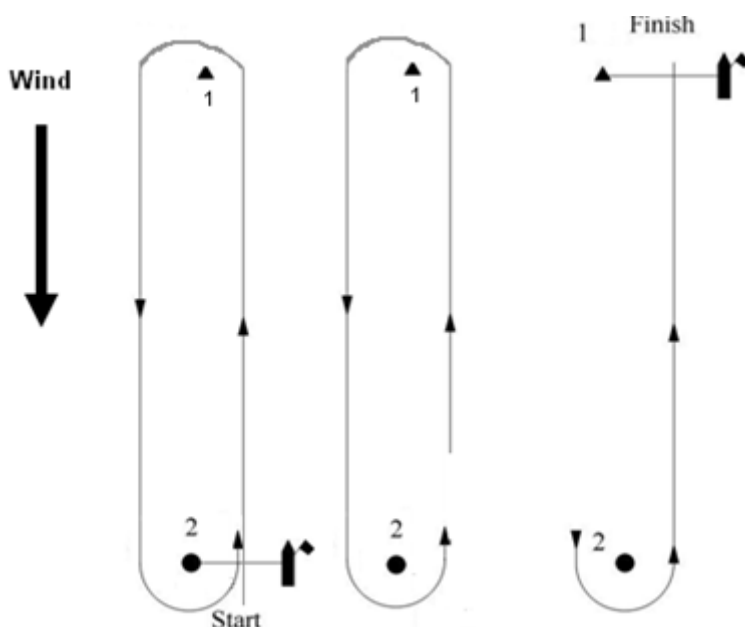


Time Limit: 3.0 Hours

Finishing Window: 30 minutes

Start – 1 – 2 – 1 – 2 – Finish

All Marks to Port



Laid Marks	Description
Start Mark/ Mark 2	Orange Cone
Finish Mark / Mark 1	Yellow & White Cube
New Mark	Orange or Yellow Cylinder with a Black Band

Flag “E” displayed with the class flag signifies that class shall sail one additional leeward leg and one additional windward leg.



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Windward-Leeward – Course 2

Indicated by display of Flag K

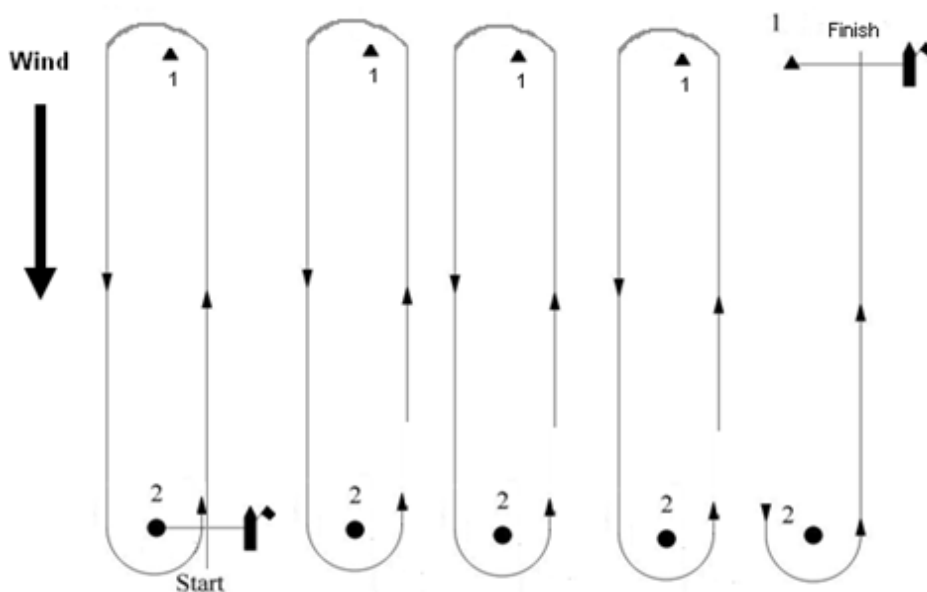


Time Limit: 3.0 Hours

Finishing Window: 30 Minutes

Start – 1 – 2 – 1 – 2 – 1 – 2 – 1 – 2 – Finish

All Marks to Port



Laid Marks	Description
Start Mark/ Mark 2	Orange Cone
Finish Mark / Mark 1	Yellow & White Cube
New Mark	Orange or Yellow Cylinder with a Black Band

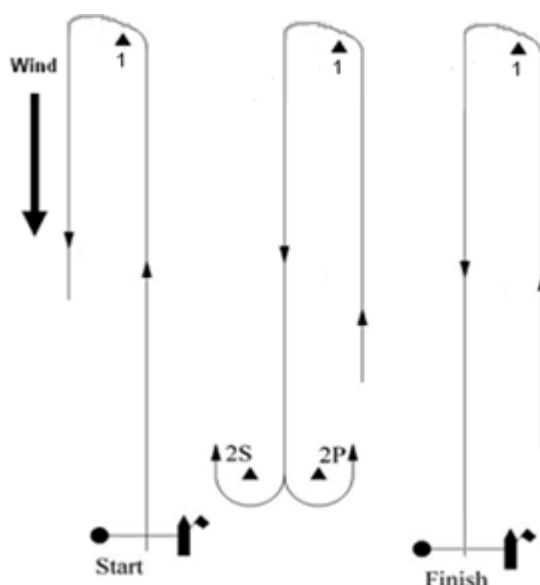
Flag “E” displayed with the class flag signifies that class shall sail one additional leeward leg and one additional windward leg.



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Windward-Leeward – Course 3

Mark 1 to Port



If one of the gate marks (2S or 2P) is missing, boats shall leave the remaining mark to PORT.

If both gate marks are missing, the Start/Finish Mark shall be the Leeward mark and be left to PORT.

Signal	Course	Time Limit & Finish Window
NP 8 over 1  	Start – 1 – Finish	50 Minutes 15 Minutes
NP 8 over 2  	Start – 1 – Gate – 1 – Finish	80 Minutes 20 Minutes
NP 8 over 3  	Start – 1 – Gate – 1 – Gate – 1 – Finish	120 Minutes 20 Minutes
NP 8 	Start – 1 – Gate – 1 – Gate – 1 – Gate – 1 - Finish	150 Minutes 30 Minutes

Laid Marks	Description
Start Mark / Finish Mark	Orange Cone
Mark 1	Yellow & White Cube
Marks (2S & 2P)	Black Cone
New Mark	Orange with Black Band

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Appendix C: Signal Flags Used in SI's

Flag Name	Design	Use
AP		Racing POSTPONED (SI 4.3)
3 rd Sub		Change to SI on water (SI 2.3)
L		Notice to Competitors ashore (SI 2.2)
P		Race Preparatory flag (SI 9)
V		Search & Rescue request (SI 1.8)
Orange		Starting line flag (S10)
Blue		Finishing line flag (SI 11)

Refer also to RRS for a complete outline of all race flags

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Revision Record

<i>Rev</i>	<i>Revision Date</i>	<i>Clause Affected/Notes</i>
VFINAL	05/10/21	Final version for release
VFINAL REVISED	25/10/21	Various amendments to SI 3.2, 5.2, 11.3, 11.4 and Appendix B
VFINAL REVISED	11/11/21	New Clause 16.2.4 and amended Appendix B Course 3